

REFERRAL INFORMATION

IMPORTANT PLEASE READ:

Please use LEXACOM for all referrals where possible.

When dictating on Lexacom, if you do not use the button to retrieve patient details from the clinical system, please type in the patient's EMIS number AND surname and then repeat this information at the beginning of your dictation as a safeguard we are typing on the correct patient – thank you

We prefer all referrals sent via Lexacom if possible – however, if there is no Lexacom in your room, please type your referral information and send via PATIENT task to the Secretarial Team (again using the correct priority).

FORMS - If you are completing any form, please save it on the patient's records and send a Lexacom dictation to the typing pool to let us know it is ready to send –for imaging, District Nurses and forms with an email address, please send yourself via Accumail

On Lexacom please send 2WW referrals as **IMMEDIATE** priority (using the drop down box)

Please note: there are 4 secretaries (Jo, Nicky, Alison & Lindsey) and we work at different sites, Jo and Nicky at Greenwood, Alison and Lindsey at Lichfield – please DO NOT print off forms and leave them in trays, although there will always be a secretary in, they could be at a different site to where you are working so all information has to be sent electronically to all of the team.

Secretaries extension numbers –

Alison	– ext 2215	Lichfield	- Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday
Lindsey	– ext 2216	Lichfield	- Wednesday, Thursday, Friday
Jo	– ext 3366	Greenwood	- Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday
Nicky	– ext 3365	Greenwood	- Tuesday, Wednesday, Friday

We mostly refer via the [EMIS integrated RF referral forms](#) within the shared folders in EMIS, although there are some - you access these via the consultation screen and save direct on the patient's records and you then notify the secretaries to send these (via Lexacom or task) if you cannot accumail them. To access these:

[Add/Document/Create Letter/\(if not in list click on looking glass bottom right but don't double click!!\)/](#) and then either use the Search function, or navigate to NHS Midlands and Lancashire CSU/MLCSU Snomed Referral Forms (choose which folder you want then choose which form you want (this will then appear next time in your drop down list). Do NOT print and fill out as this will duplicate them on the patient's records. Save the form and then do your Lexacom referral to let the secretaries know you have a form to send. In the A-Z information below it will say if there is a form you need to complete.

Please note, if you use the Search function, it can bring up all forms with keyword in the title, so this could mean from different hospitals – please check you have the right form before completing. Also try using different search words, i.e. dermatology/skin, colorectal/lower GI

2WW REFERRALS – please access these forms via Web in 2WW folder which will autopopulate and you fill in the rest of the form and save in patient's records. These will only be accepted on E-Referral Service now.

We generally refer to Queen's Hospital Burton – please see the codes pages on resources page.

PLEASE NOTE: Burton do not accept under 25's for any speciality except Dermatology and Breast.

If you are sending 2WW Dermatology to WHT (Manor Hospital) or RWT (New Cross) then this is via the Health Harmonie 2WW form for image capture – you need to state where the lesion is and size – and if there is more than one, you need this information for each lesion. Referrals will be rejected without.

Please then send a Lexacom Dictation marked **Immediate. AND PLEASE ENSURE YOU INSTRUCT PATIENT TO CONTACT US A WEEK LATER IF THEY HAVE HEARD NOTHING.**

Full instructions are attached at the bottom of this document. Please note that you need to use the Derby Breast Referral form for Burton. Also, check you are using the correct form – there is no Brain/CNS service at Burton and we are not able to refer to the QEHB, you need to refer to either New Cross or Stoke (UHNM).

Breast Pain Only Service – patients can be seen at the Community Breast Pain Clinic held at either Samuel Johnson or Sir Robert Peel Hospitals. This is for breast pain only in the absence of absolutely any other breast symptoms at all (stressing that as they will reject) Also no males, no history of implants, no previous history of breast Ca, and conservative measures must be tried in primary care first (supportive bra, NSAID gel, Paracetamol, breast pain diary).

If no improvement then complete the form and we will refer via ERS. you need to advise the patient as usual that they are to be available in the next 2 weeks, and tell them they will receive an appointment through the post, but if they don't hear within a week to call the surgery.

(secretaries – refer on ERS as Urgent/Surgery Breast/Other symptomatic (2WW))

Note: For Burton 2WW breast referrals, Derby have taken over booking appointments. There is a new form but it is saved under the Burton 2WW (but make sure it is the Derby form).

TEMPORARY RESIDENTS - Please be aware we are not able to refer temporary residents via ERS.

Children 2WW referrals to dermatology are by form and emailed to bcw.appointments@nhs.net

Also please remember the HEFT Trust has now merged with the University Hospitals of Birmingham – so for any 2 week waits, even though we are requesting Good Hope, you need to make them aware that due to them having to meet a time limit of seeing the pt within 14 days, they may be offered an appointment at any one of the UHB/HEFT hospitals, which includes Birmingham, Heartlands and Solihull.

As of July 2022, the practice has joined the pilot scheme for FIT Testing prior to some 2WW colorectal referrals for Queen's Hospital Burton and Good Hope Hospital (HEFT) - these are for change in bowel symptom referrals and rectal bleeding, unexplained weight loss and abdo pain (patients presenting with rectal mass or abdominal mass still have immediate 2WW referral).

Please request via ICE only via the online test request in a consultation.

T:\Darwin Shared System\Darwin - Resources for clinicians\Referral Information\FIT Test Patient List

FIT Tests - As soon as you are registered on ICE please request any FIT tests via online as below:

When **in your consultation** select from the menu on the left hand side:

- Test Request and choose Online Test Request
- Select UHDB University Hospitals Derby and Burton

- Select Faeces on left hand menu (it is towards the bottom of the column)
- Select Burton Fit Kit Request
- Select Continue with request
- Select your name from the drop down list next to Requesting Consultant/GP
- Type in your clinical details
- Select Place request on the right hand side
- Select Accept Request at the bottom of the screen

Wait for the request to go through – it will accept and take you back to EMIS and it will log the request it on your screen. If you are not in an open consultation it will not log it in EMIS, but you can see the request in the patient's Diary under Completed Test Requests.

Radiology Request Forms – Please use ICE if you are registered – if not, please speak to your mentor/on-call GP as it will have to go via them as at 18.2.26 Burton have said they will only accept ICE referrals for imaging that is available on their ICE catalogue. Secretaries are unable to see this as they are not registered so cannot advise what is available so please try in the first instance. If not, there are signed forms which are integrated and accessed via EMIS Web from the consultation screen and these can be sent via Accumail once you have completed the form – there is no walk-in service. (Trainees, please use your mentor's signed forms if you cannot find the referral in the catalogue).

Re ICE: Please see the shared system for the training notes (T:\Darwin Shared System\Darwin - Training and guidance\ICE Pathology and Radiology)

According to your job role, when you access the online test request area you will see the options open to you (i.e. if you have permission to refer for X-rays etc, then the radiology tab will be present).

Any queries regarding your ICE login/registration, please contact Sharon Bean, Business Support Manager/ Business Admin Team. Thank you.

Requesting Radiology New GP/Locums/New Trainees (please see exclusions below)

As above, we have now moved to ICE, the online test request function. If the imaging test you need is not in the ICE catalogue then please use the signed paper forms.

To access for the first time you will need to use the looking glass to find them, but they then should stay in your list. If they do drop out you just need to go through the process to select them again:

In your open consultation:

Select Document from the left hand side

Select the Looking glass bottom right corner

Click ONCE on Darwin Doctors Referral Forms

Click ONCE on Imaging

Click ONCE on your Mentor's named folder (i.e. James)

Double Click on the form you want and it should load.

The list of forms available are:

Cannock MRI

CT for Burton

DEXA for Burton

MRI for Burton

USS for SJH

X-Ray for SJH

DXA Scan for Cannock – NOTE: these are access via the shared folders as they are a controlled document and we cannot modify – search DXA and the document is called RF758 RWT DXA Scan Referral v2 260325 and these will be accepted via email if not modified.

For radiology forms and any other community form (i.e. District Nurses etc) that have an email on the form you can now use ACCUMAIL which is a safe NHS.net email pathway direct from the patient's consultation.

Once you have completed and saved the form, stay on the patient and select the @ tab on your Accurx toolbar, steps as below:

- Select the @ tab which will load an information box and on the right hand side click on 'Attach document from EMIS Web for imaging referral'
- Your patient's details will appear in a box, check they are correct and select and their documents will load
- Tick the box next to your imaging request you have just saved and select 'Attach'
- The document will be scanned for email addresses and you need to select uhdb.admin.radiology@nhs.net Just be careful as it will also bring up our practice email address which is in the referral form.
- This will create an email. If it is urgent then tick the box on the top right.
- Once you are happy you are on the right patient and have selected the right document, then click on Send Now on the bottom right. It will automatically save to the patient's notes.

There are many community forms you can also Accumail as below:

- District Nurses
- ECG, Home BP and Echo forms to Burton (for over 16's over)
- Falls Team
- Community Physiotherapy/OT
- Adult Dietician Form to MPFT
- Specialist diabetes team MPFT
- Any MPFT form with an email on the form.
- CAMHS/Mental Health Hub
- Chronic Pain Management Team
- Paediatric Physiotherapy form
- Adult podiatry form
- Lymphoedema form to St Giles
- Semen analysis Nurture Fertility

If you are not sure, please check.

MRI scanner at Cannock

This is sent via ERS – please complete the form in FULL answering all the safety questions and send to the secretaries. Please be mindful that this is a mobile unit on a carpark and has steps up to access the unit so may not be suitable for people with mobility issues. They do not do under 19's or contrast MRIs. The service is run by Diagnostic Healthcare and for NHS patient enquiries and Clinical enquiries you can contact them on:

Tel: 0161 929 5679 / 0330 058 4142

Email: info@dhc.uk.com

Please see radiology exclusions below:

For ultrasounds there is also the option of Health Harmonie Community Service– the secretaries send these via ERS to HH - please complete the form and send via dictation file on Lexacom or via patient task. Secretaries – please pick Tamworth option as there is no Burntwood option now. Thank.

RADIOLOGY EXCLUSIONS USS- Please note for Burton Trust they do not accept direct access USS request for:

Breast/axilla (these would go to Breast Team at Burton)

Groin/hernias (refer direct to Consultant)

Morton's Neuroma – this is a clinical diagnosis and they no longer offer imaging to primary care in this context – if clinically convincing you are advised to treat in the first instance and then secondary care referral if it is not possible to manage symptoms.

Please Note: as at 5/2/22 they will now accept direct access referrals for neck/thyroid (previously they didn't). These requests will be vetted by a specialist Head and Neck Radiologist or Specialist Sonographer and may be declined if there is insufficient clinical information to justify the scan. You are reminded that it is the responsibility of the requesting clinician to review and action the results. Any incidental findings should be addressed as required, e.g on occasion this may require advice from specialties outside of ENT and should be sought by the colleague requesting the imaging. Patients requiring an ENT opinion can, of course, be referred in the usual manner.

RADIOLOGY PROTOCOL/EXCLUSIONS FOR X-RAYS

Please Note: as at 22.11.21 – Burton Trust have reviewed their plain film Protocols to align them with IRMER guidelines best practice and the Royal College of Radiologist iRefer Guidelines for justification of exposure. The following amendments have been made to the referral criteria for Lumbar and Cervical spine X-rays and Calcaneal Spur X-rays:

Lumbar Spine X-Rays – will only be accepted for the following clinical indications:

- Suspected fracture from significant trauma with pain or neurological deficit.
- Suspected osteoporotic collapse
- Pathological fracture.

They will NOT be performed in the following common clinical situations:

Scoliosis (spinal consultant referral only)

- Acute back pain with or without sciatica (MRI should be considered after trial of conservative management)
- Chronic back pain.

Any patients with red flag symptoms should be considered for immediate referral to spinal surgery or an urgent MRI for lumbar spine imaging.

Cervical Spine X-rays - will only be accepted for the following clinical indications:

- Neck injury with pain or neurological deficit, unconscious head injury (?fracture/dislocation)
- Congenital disorders, atlanto-axial subluxation, osteoporotic collapse, osteomyelitis, bone tumour
- Position post-surgery
- Pre-op evaluation of flexibility where there is known rheumatoid arthritis or ankylosis
- Spinal stability

They will NOT be performed in the following common clinical situations:

- Suspected degenerative change in the absence of neurological deficit
- If there is a strong suspicion of malignancy/metastasis or infection (discitis/osteomyelitis) then MRI should be considered.

Calcaneal Spur X-rays – new IR(ME)R Protocol – Imaging is rarely contributory to the diagnosis of calcaneal spur and should only be requested by a specialist where clear value can be added.

Any queries contact the department on 01283 593268

Please note for Health Harmonie they have an exclusion list on their referral form (including ?cancer, obstetric care, USS guided injections, breast, cardiac imaging, chest, reology, superficial masses or lumps in the neck, thyroid, axilla or groin, no children under 18).

Do not use the Queen's Hospital form for ultrasounds – this is only for CT scans or MRI scans if you want a different scanner than Cannock. There is an open scanner at QHB – please state on form if you are requesting this.

MRI referrals are generally sent to Cannock via a separate form (integrated on EMIS) and are emailed – Please note: Cannock do not accept referrals for babies/young children, they have to be sedated and will need to be admitted on a day case so these need to go the Burton. Cannock do not see under 18's. There is a weight limit at Cannock, please check and make sure you complete the safety questions. This is a mobile unit so there are steps so not accessible for mobility issues. Burton do not sedate adults.

Please note: there is no GP direct access service to **Good Hope or the Manor or New Cross or Birmingham for radiology, as confirmed in Sept 2020 – if you want a patient to attend any hospital for radiology other than Burton Trust, then you will need to refer to a consultant.**

Please see the list below for an alphabetical list of services and where to refer:

Please note, since paper switch off (which all hospitals in this area have implemented), all first Consultant appointments need to be booked via ERS or they will be rejected (this does not apply to community clinics etc).

General Referrals – (in alphabetical order, or use the Find function ctrl F+9

Action for Children is no longer signposted to by GP's.

Please INSTEAD, can you use the New Stay Well service which will support hundreds of Staffordshire children and young people

From 1 April a new service called 'Stay Well' will provide emotional health and wellbeing support for children and young people aged five to 18 years old (25 years with SEND) in Staffordshire.

The service will also help families and professionals gain the knowledge and confidence to create an emotionally healthy environment and support children and young people.

Stay Well will offer early intervention and prevention through:

- Group and one-to-one emotional health and wellbeing sessions for children and young people
- Peer support groups for children and young people
- Access to a wide range of positive activities for children and young people
- Information, advice and guidance for children and young people, families, professionals and schools
- Workshops and training opportunities for children, young people, families, professionals and schools

The service will be provided from local venues across Staffordshire, including wellbeing centres, community venues, schools and colleges.

[Find out more about the service.](#)

How to make a referral

Children, young people and their families can refer directly into the service, or they can be referred by a professional.

Call: 01782 418 518 (select Option 2)

Online: [Stay Well online referral form](#)

Anti-Viral Treatment Referrals for High Risk Covid Patients – as at 22.6.23

Should a patient who considers themselves at high risk present to the practice, they should be referred to Staffordshire and Stoke-on-Trent CMDU.

Please email NSGPFEDCMDU@StaffsStokeCCGs.nhs.uk with the following details:

- Patient Name, date of birth, NHS number
- Contact phone number for the patient
- What clinical condition the referrer thinks may make them eligible for antiviral treatment
- What was the date of their positive covid test / onset of covid symptoms

The CMDU will contact the patient directly, usually within 24-48 hours of receiving the referral from the practice.

Please be aware, if the anti-virals are prescribed this will be done electronically and the patient then has to find a pharmacy that actually have them – this can prove slightly difficult as not many of them are keeping them in stock – after speaking to the Services Manager at Stoke she gave the following advice: (obviously this only appears to cover from the Cannock area, we are unsure about the stock levels in Burntwood).

“These are the pharmacies that either Amin or myself have spoken to. They have agreed to keep the stock, but please bear in mind that this is on a good will basis.

Norfolk Street Pharmacy (1-5 Norfolk St, Hanley ST1 4PB) – 01782 272027

Middleport Pharmacy (185 Newcastle St, Stoke-on-Trent ST6 3QJ) - 01782 818494

Waterloo Pharmacy (68 The Strand, Longton, ST3 2NR) – 11782 342955

Boots (Orbital Retail Park, Norton Canes, Cannock, WS11 8XP) - 01543 503784

Asda (Queensway, Stafford ST16 3TA) – 01785 782010

Boots (Queens Retail Park Stafford, ST17 4SU) - 01785 245736

Peel Court Pharmacy (2 Aldergate, Tamworth, B79 7DJ) - 01827 63118

We also had a query from a pharmacy, who have informed us they now keep Paxlovid as stock;

Dean and Smedley Ltd (65-67 Horninglow Road, Burton-on-Trent, DE14 2PP) - 01283 568711”

AAA Surveillance Programme Referrals

For patient's who have been found to have an aortic aneurysm and need surveillance, we refer to Derby via email to dhft.AAAscreening@nhs.net

Anti-Coagulation Referrals to QHB

We do not do many of these as we manage most patients in the practice but if you do then the referral needs to go via Derby on ERS (Choose Haematology – Anticoag – Warfarin only – comes up as telephone clinic).

ADHD/ASD –

ADHD Children NHS – age 6-10 to Community Paediatrics, age 11-18 to CAMHS, via the Neurodevelopmental form – this is a long form and they prefer it to be completed by someone who knows the child well so they are better to be done via school. There is an information letter on Accurx you can send which gives the information.

ASD Children NHS – age 5-18 use the Neurodevelopmental form as above and send to CYP Autism team - for referrals for Autism in Children under 5 years please complete the Community Paediatric referral form, so that the child's development can be assessed in the first instance.

ADHD/ASD Children RTC – patient to research and complete the requisite forms required by the RTC provider and return to the practice and GP to decide if a referral is warranted. Please send them an Accurx link with the information sheet (in Accurx templates named: "Child ADHD/ASD info to Parent re RTC/NHS referrals")

ADHD Adult NHS - patients can go to MPFT via their form with no ASRS required, they will screen – they do want the mental health history and please complete the risk questions.

ASD Adult NHS - patients can go to MPFT via their form with no AQ50 required, they will screen – they do want the mental health history and please complete the risk questions.

ASD Adult RTC – sent them the Accurx with leaflet which gives them information on what to do. (template Accurx is "Adult ASD Referral Information Leaflet")

ADHD Adult RTC – this is now being managed by the ICB referral management team as below: (F12 protocol to send forms – ADHD referrals)

The ICB have set up a new portal for ADHD referrals. We need to follow the following process:

- Patient completes form A/B – please send to reception who can send form via email – if you want to create it yourself you need to add a new document from within the correct patient records, search for ADHD and select document PRF020 (which auto-fills pt details), save it to their records and then email it to them (please send via email if possible as it's a long form).
- Patient returns completed form & its scanned & workflowed to a doctor.
- Doctor completes Form C (answers are within form A/B) – add new document, search for ADHD and select document PRF021 within EMIS
- Doctor saves completed form C (PRF021) to pt records and sends referral request to secretaries who upload forms A/B (PRF020) and C (PRF021) to the portal.

Many thanks

Alcohol (and/or Drug) – we refer to STARS which is now a self-referral now that can only be done online by the patient so please send the Accurx link – if in doubt if the patient will complete it and you want secretaries to do it, then you need to give as much relevant information as possible as below or the secretaries will not be able to complete and send this!

1. **Can we contact you by telephone or mobile?**
2. **Can we say who we are by text or verbal message?**
3. **Can we contact you by letter?**
4. **Our services have trained volunteers, can a volunteer contact you?**
5. **Do you have any disabilities?**
6. **Do you have any literacy difficulties?**
7. **Do you need an Interpreter?**
8. **Do you drink alcohol?**
If yes: Amount and How Often?
9. **Do you use drugs?**

If yes: Amount and How Often?

The following questions give us the information we need to prioritise your referral.

Are you or your partner pregnant?

Do you have any current or previous mental health concerns?

Do you have involvement with other services? For e.g. Social Care, probation, CMHT, Health Visitor
Please specify

Do you have any physical health conditions or symptoms which are likely to require treatment?
Please specify

Do you want to tell us anything else?

Please note: they need an email address for this to work – if not we assume that we will have to use our email.

Allergy Referral – for skin prick tests locally you can use the Lung Function form on EMIS to send to Cannock which will be emailed to the Respiratory Bookings Team. Please note, as from January 2024 the clinic has been suspended due to manufacturing challenges required for the test. They will let the practice know when the service resumes. For clinical immunology hospital referral the choices are currently County Hospital (Stafford), Heartlands Hospital, Birmingham Treatment Centre or Royal Stoke Hospital (as at August 2023).

Antenatal Physiotherapy – these need to be done via letter direct to the Physiotherapy department at Burton (secretaries will email referrals) – SJH or SRP do NOT see pregnancy related issues for physio – we do not send these to MSK Service.

Anticoagulant Therapy – we have an in-house service – contact Ros Needham. Some patients may be under the care of WDS at Burton although these will all be transferred to our care in due course

Audiology Burton Trust – July 2024 - we have been notified by Burton that due to high demand, they have temporarily stopped seeing any routine audiology referrals include age-related hearing loss – this applies to SJH, SRP and QHB. Therefore, all routine patients should only be offered AQP providers such as Specsavers, regardless of the patient's choice if they want to go to SJH.

***Audiology** – New option for people to self-refer into Community Audiology/Adult Hearing Services

New guidance from NHS England requires all integrated care systems to put in place self-referral routes for audiology services, including hearing aid provision, where GP involvement is not clinically necessary. The requirement is set out in the [2023/24 priorities and planning guidance](#) and needed to be in place by September 2023.

Under the guidance, people who require NHS funded hearing assessments and hearing aids from the community audiology service will be able to self-refer directly to a provider of their choice without first being referred by a GP. This will be facilitated by way of an ICB self-referral form. The form, along with further information, can be found [here](#).

An initial assessment will still be undertaken by the audiology provider to ensure the person presenting with hearing difficulties is suitable for the service. This was previously undertaken by the GP/referrer but will now be completed by the audiology provider using the information provided on the referral form. Please note that the standard option of referral via GP will still be available, e.g., via eRS alongside self-referral and all communication regarding patient outcomes will continue.

To assist with the implementation of the self-referral option, GP practices are asked for their support in:

- advising patients of the choice to self-refer.
- providing a link to the ICB self-referral form (available [here](#)), or a printed version (available [here](#)) and informing people to contact the provider/store of their choice, from the list provided on the form. People can either use the contact details provided or walk-in to the service.
- providing people with their NHS number, if requested, as providers will also require this as part of the self-referral process.
- Promoting the self-referral option via your social media channels and/or displaying materials in the practice. A toolkit can be found [here](#), which includes social media graphics, text and a poster to be displayed.

Please note: an Accurx has been set up for this and reception will be told that they can send it to patients

If they find they are not eligible and come back to you, then dictate an audiology referral and we will send the patient a choice of clinics.

Any hearing aid reassessment with hearing aids must go back to their provider in the first 3 years.

For housebound audiology referrals – Please do a letter and we can email it to Specsavers at Tamworth and they will organise. Like for any audiology referrals, you must state the ears are free from wax.

(secretaries – email for Specsavers Tamworth is specsavershearing.tamworth@nhs.net)
homevisits.birmingham2.uk@specsavers.com

For children's audiology assessment please refer to Community Audiology at The Coach House in Lichfield (secretaries – there is a template letter in EMIS) (Samuel Johnson do not do children audiology clinics and we need school details please).

Autism – Adult (Assessment and Diagnosis) – We now send these to the local MPFT service at Lichfield. For this service, we do not need a completed AQ50 as they will carry out the assessment. An AQ50 is still required for any Right to Choose service. Please note: current wait times from referral to first appt is 14 months – then a further 12 months for diagnosis. You cannot expedite these referrals, they are a routine service only.

Bariatric Surgery – please see W for Weight Management

Benign Skin Lesions – we do not routinely refer for these – please see the ICB guidance for procedures of low clinical value: [Policy for Low Clinical Value Procedures Staffordshire](#) There is a Health Harmonie Community Dermatology Service but they are still subject to the PoLCV

Breast clinics routine – NOTE: ALL BREAST REFERRALS (including cancer not suspected) ARE SEEN WITHIN 2 WEEKS so the patient has to be made aware that are to be available to attend in that timeframe. DERBY now deals with all our breast referrals but the patients are still seen at the Burton Breast Unit and these have to be booked via e-RS so like the 2WW above, they will have an appointment sent to them, but to contact us if they don't hear within a week. Please dictate the referral letter. (GHH, Manor, and County have Breast Clinics too) (for Breast Screening only please contact South Staffordshire Breast Screening at Derby (within criteria, not family history). Community

Hospitals (SJH/Cannock) have breast pain clinics only (see below), so all other referrals have to be a base hospital. Any axilla swellings/lumps need to be referred to Breast Clinic, do not refer direct for USS as they will be rejected.

For direct Breast Care referrals (i.e. prosthesis replacement) these need to be sent direct to the Breast Care Unit at Burton via email – as at 29.05.24 it was to email elaine.clifford2@nhs.net and copy in shelley.serman@nhs.net

Breast Pain Referrals

There is now a local service for just breast pain only running clinics in Samuel Johnson and Sir Robert Peel Hospitals. Please check the eligibility criteria below before referring and please use the specific form: Any physical findings AT ALL will not be accepted (even pre-existing ones like a known cyst).

- Patient has breast pain only – no other symptoms AT ALL
- Primary care management has been attempted (regular NSAID or Paracetamol, lifestyle and bra advice etc)
- Patient does not have breast implants
- Patient has no previous history of breast cancer
- No male patients

Breast Reduction

Cosmetic operations on breast (female) Patients are ONLY eligible for surgery to reduce breast size if the following criteria are met:

- The patient is suffering from functional problems: neck ache, backache and/or intertrigo, where any possible causes of these conditions have been considered and excluded

AND

- Symptoms are not relieved by physiotherapy and a professionally fitted brassiere has not relieved symptoms

AND

- The patient has a body mass index (BMI) within the range 18kg/m² and 25kg/m² AND • Have a cup size of F+

AND

- Be 21 years of age or over Patients should have an initial assessment prior to an appointment with a consultant plastic surgeon to ensure that these criteria are met. At, or following, this assessment there should be access to a trained bra fitter where it is available.

AND

- There is an expected need to remove at least 500g of tissue from each breast

Breast Screening - Women who are aged 50-70 and are registered with a GP are automatically invited for screening every three years. This means patients will first be invited for screening between their 50th and 53rd birthday, although in some areas some patients may be invited from the age of 47 as part of the trial extension of the programme (47-73). If the patient has not heard before their 53rd birthday then there is no need to chase, they will be contacted in due course. If the patient is over the age of 70 (73 in areas where the trial is in place), they will stop receiving screening invitations. However, they are still eligible for screening and can arrange an appointment directly with the local breast screening unit (Derby 01332 785336)

Please note, prior to Burton Trust taking over all breast screening for our area, some patients were being seen for breast screening at Cannock Hospital – this is now no longer possible for any of our patients and they will have to attend either a mobile unit or Burton Hospital for their screening.

Breathlessness Pathway Cannock Hospital – this is part of the new Community Diagnostic Centre pathways and can be accessed by ERS. Please complete the the form on EMIS (their requirements are for bloods FBC, TSH, Renal, BNP. An ECG in last 3 months. A chest X-ray). Once the form is completed, please send a Lexacom to us so we can send via ERS.

Cardiorespiratory Open Access Diagnostics Referral QHB – you can refer direct to Burton for an **Echocardiogram, 24 BP monitor or Home ECG (either 24 hour or 7 day, referral will be triaged and allocated on frequency of symptoms** – this is for technical reports only, if you wish them to be reviewed by cardiology then you must now refer them via ERS into Cardiology (this is a change from previously when you could just tick the box or write it on the form). The form is integrated on WEB – can you please complete, save and let the secretaries know via urgent Lexacom/task so we can send. You cannot sent to Cannock Hospital for an echo, this service was suspected in February 2023.

CAMHS – there is a referral form on EMIS and we email via CaFSPA and referrals will be directed to Holly Lodge at St Michael's Court. Please get as much information as you can including the school the child attends and note we do not arrange repeat medication, they go back to CAMHS for this. ADHD referrals – needs to be organised by the education provider – please see Neurodevelopmental form information in 'A'

CARDIAC NURSING/THE HEART FAILURE/TEAM (southHFSN@mpft.nhs.uk)

New referrals to the service can only be generated by the hospitals **NOT the GP**. Patients in the Burntwood area are referred to Stoneydelph Health Centre, Ellerbeck, Tamworth, Staffs contact numbers:

01827 306115 Rebecca Jackson – Cardiac Nurse

01827 306116 Jane Fulford – Cardiac Nurse

01827 306119 Angela Hemphill - Administrator

Cataracts (see GOS 18 notes) can be referred to Cannock, Manor, Good Hope, New Cross, Queen's Hospital (**not** SRP or SJH). The patient has to be referred via an accredited optician only, either direct by the optician or via us on the Cataract Referral form if the optician sends it to us.

Children's Learning Disability Team – based at The Friary Centre, Lichfield. There is a form on EMIS to complete – please complete in FULL or it will be rejected.

The Children's Learning Disability Team is an NHS service that provide specialist mental health support to Children's Learning Disability Team

The Friary,
St. Michael's Court,
Trent Valley Rd,
Lichfield,
WS13 6EF
[0300 790 7000](tel:03007907000) ext 7021512
childrensld.team@nhs.net

Children's Occupational Therapy -The service accepts appropriate referrals for children from 0 to 19 years of age who have either a physical disability or movement difficulty. This is a service which focuses on the physical skills of a child. Therefore they only see children who have mental health conditions such as ASD or ADHD **if** there is a clear physical difficulty occurring alongside this. Please complete the form on EMIS in FULL including **SCHOOL** details.

East Team (Lichfield, Tamworth and East Staffordshire)
Children's Occupational Therapy
Wilnecote Health Centre
49 Smithy Lane
Wilnecote
Tamworth, B77 5LB
Tel: [01782 427 450](tel:01782427450) Email: childrensOTsouth@mpft.nhs.uk

Children/Paediatric Referrals – please note, for ANY children referrals you need to supply the secretaries with the child's **SCHOOL** details – thanks (see physiotherapy for details on children's physio referrals).

Child Protection Conferences – if you receive a request for a report in the event you cannot attend the conference, please use the form they supply to send your responses. You can either use the form in EMIS as we have an integrated version (Darwin Doctors Referral Forms/Community, Clinic and Nursing Referrals/Paediatrics Young Persons/Child Protection Conference Report Proforma). Easiest way is to search in your looking glass 'Child protection'. Of there is a hard copy saved on the shared drive under Referrals which you can follow then answer in turn whilst dictating to us.

Child Assessment for ASD and ADHD – needs to be organised by the education provider – please see Neurodevelopmental form information under ADHD and ASD above in 'A'

Child MRI Referrals – please note, for babies and young children that need an MRI they will have to be sedated so need to be admitted on a day case so will have to go to Burton (Cannock do not see under 18's).

Children's SALT – via form on EMIS to Greenhill Health Centre.

Children Dermatology – via A&G service to Burton – see Paediatric Dermatology

Child – Assessment for Dyslexia – The advice from CaFSPA is that if there are concerns around dyslexia, they would recommend that the family speak with the child's teacher who can link with the School's Special Education Needs Coordinator who can carry out screening assessments. The schools fund Educational Psychology assessments but they are a very small resource so it would be a school decision for whether to request and fund the assessment or not.

Chronic Fatigue Service – There is a CFS referral form to Derby Hospital on EMIS. To send via EMIS put the Derby hospital post code in at the beginning and it should bring up all the different clinics and we refer to them via the Rehab clinic. Please complete the form in full and note the patient needs to meet all the diagnostic criteria and also note they require specific bloods to be done prior to referral and will not accept a referral without them.

(FBC, ESR, CRP, U&E, LFT, Calcium, HbA1c, Thyroid Function, Coeliac screen, Creatine Kinase, Serum Ferritin, Vitamin D).

CFS at Cannock – refer via form but also can send letter but we have to state the patient has already been diagnosed with CFS – they are not a diagnostic service. Send to Clinical Health Psychology Dept, Level 2 Therapy Services, Cannock Hospital. (Tel 01543 576609) - PLEASE ENSURE YOU CHECK FORMS FOR REQUIRED BLOODS ETC, referrals will be rejected without the requisite investigation results.

Chronic Pain Management Service – based at Edwin House, Burton – patients will be seen at a local clinic, normally Lichfield. Please complete the integrated form on EMIS and send to the secretaries will who refer via ERS or email – contact number is 01283 507131. Do not send to hospitals, they just redirect them back to the patient's local Chronic Pain Management Team. Over 18's only.

Clinical Genetics Referral (Family History Form) – can you please print off the form and give to the patient to complete and return to us – the GP then fills the bottom part out and we can photocopy it and send it to the B'ham Women's hospital. There is a copy on EMIS.

Colposcopy Referrals – patients can attend at Sir Robert Peel or Burton – referrals need to be sent via ERS – Gynaecology/NOS

Community Intervention Team Nurses – send via the District Nurse form (integrated on WEB) to the SPA for Health and Social Care (can be emailed via secretaries)

Email: sst-tr.bltspace@nhs.net

Emergency Spa Phone: 07772944024 (not for patient use)

Community Matron – send via Community Matron form (different to the DN one) (it is integrated on WEB) to the SPA for Health and Social Care (can be emailed via secretaries) – please complete form and send an URGENT lexacom dictation to let secretaries know to send.

Community Paediatrics – for developmental concerns refer via form (**need this to be completed correctly including the school details**) to the East Community Paediatrics Team (patients will be allocated to the nearest outreach clinic) – please also refer under 5's is querying ASD to rule out development problems first. Tel: 01283 505160. We can email this form MPFT.Paedsreferrals@nhs.net. Please see exclusion list below:

EXCLUSION CRITERIA:

- General medical conditions: for example asthma, eczema, joint pains or headaches
- Autism assessments or diagnosis over the age of 5 (see Neurodevelopment referral advice -
- Behavioural issues (this should initially be referred to Family Support Services).
- Emotional Health and Wellbeing support (this is provided by Action 4 Children)
- Tics and Tourette's syndrome
- Dyslexia and specific learning difficulties (this should be referred to school/Educational Psychologists for assessment)
- Obesity and growth problems (please contact your GP for support with this)
- Constipation (GP or Constipation clinic provided by Community Children's Nurses)
- Sleep Issues
- Feeding problems
- Diagnosing Learning Disability

Continence Service – They are now called Specialist Pelvic Health Team -there is a form on EMIS web to complete (even for pads) and we can email to mpft.spht@nhs.net. You must rule out UTI prior to referral and put details of date and result – see below! Their telephone contact numbers are 01543 441434/441427 - please complete form and send task to **Team Leaders – TB & AB**

Please note as per my email in August 2023 - The service has changed a lot since COVID as they took all of the referrals from the District Nurses at that time to triage to reduce their workload - this has basically continued and their team structure is changing currently and further information will be sent out to practices in the near future - we need to send all referrals to them (except EOL and routine catheter changes then straight to DNs) which are triaged (RAG rated) and placed on an appropriate wait list.

Therefore it is extremely important that adequate and pertinent information is sent, with any discharge letters or urology letters we have if applicable. This could mean the difference to the patient being assessed in a month or put on the routine 40 week wait list.

Incontinence Pads - Regarding containment products, they have stressed they are not a pad service. They have identified that many people using pads are actually treatable so therefore all patients requesting pads need an assessment first before pads are considered, even if they are currently buying them. Patients need to be told they have to buy pads in the interim until this assessment takes place. If treatable and the patient is not compliant with treatment then pads will not be provided.

Red flags have to be ruled out; i.e. infection etc so first line treatment has been completed and therefore a urine sample must be completed. However if you have a housebound patient using pads and red flags ruled out and it is a functional incontinence but unable to get urine sample as using pads etc, then put this information on the form to save it getting rejected.

For this triage service to work effectively for the patient, they need as much information as possible to avoid a delay for the patient.

Counselling- Wellbeing Matters You can refer to Wellbeing Matters which is a self-referral system for the patients to make contact. Please generate a referral leaflet to give the patient (In consultations, create document and choose/search for “Self referral to Wellbeing service given”, print off and then save. This generates the codes needed for the referral).

CUES (Community Urgent Eyecare Service)

0333 015 0122

Mon-Sat 9am-5pm

For guidance Please see the link to the information on DORA: [CUES - Guidance + Eligibility](#)

Datix Link - report any soft intelligence/events through the following link: (you need to make an account and log in so it brings up our area etc) – please access link through DORA.

The doctors have an exact copy of the online form they fill out to give us the information and we then can upload the information on the web form

Dementia/Memory – Please refer to the Dementia Services (East) via the Memory/Dementia Clinic Referral form (based at Park House, Cannock) via Access Team (Tel: 0300 555 5001)

YOU MUST ARRANGE THE RELEVANT BLOOD TESTS AND DO A GPCOG/6CIT before the referral can go - Bloods required: B12, Folate, FBC, LFT, U&E, TFT, Lipids, HbA1c, Serum Calcium and eGFR.

Dental Community - Cannock Hospital has a Dental Department – for community referrals we need to send a referral letter with as much detail as possible to justify the reason why they should be accepted and state if a housebound visit needed – this will be triaged by a dentist to decide. We can email referrals to DentalClinicCannock@mpft.nhs.uk Phone number is: 01543 576210

Dermatology – Adult/Paediatric – We are unable to refer adult or paediatric dermatology to the **Manor** anymore as they do not accept referrals from Staffordshire CCGs.

Likewise, there are no dermatology clinics at **Cannock or New Cross** that we can refer to anymore, they are using the Circle which is the equivalent of our Health Harmonie provider and we are out of their area for this.

(Note: as from 1.10.23 for Paediatric dermatology referrals, UHDB are now using A&G only – see ‘P’ below)

Dermatology Health Harmonie will see all ages, but no under 16 year olds for any surgical procedures.

Dermatology Good Hope – we are no longer able to refer to them direct, this has to be thought Health Harmonie first and if necessary they refer onwards.

Important – Please do not refer benign skin lesions, warts, verrucas, molluscm etc – these fall under the Procedures of Low Clinical Value – if unsure check the policy [ICB Policy - Procedures of Low Clinical Value](#)

Dermatology – Teledermatology via Consultant Connect

(Ctrl +click on link above)

Diabetic Clinics – for Lichfield/Tamworth send all referrals to Stoneydelph Health Centre to the Primary Care Specialist Diabetes team - Please **see RF MPFT Diabetes team integrated form on EMIS** and we will send by email. To refer to a Consultant at Samuel Johnson, please dictate.

If you want to refer to the Diabetes Centre at Queen's Hospital these can be sent via email (bhft.diabetescentre@nhs.net). Urgent referrals first need to be called through on **01283 593113 option 2 (this will take you to receptionist)**.

Please note there is also a DESMOND/MY DIABETES form on EMIS, tick which service you require and notify the secretaries so we can send.

Diabetic Retinopathy – eligible patients are picked up via the system coding automatically – we do not refer to them via secretaries.

Dietician (Adult – over 18's) – Via form (**see integrated form on EMIS Web in Referrals Folder**) to Adult Specialist Dietetic Service at Beecroft Court in Cannock. This is in the integrated WEB referral folder and you can either dictate or autopopulate and complete the form yourself and then send a message on Lexacom for us to email. Please put a comment in the Consultant/Specialty box that it is a Dietician Form to send. Thanks.

(link to their services: [Dietetics \(Adult\) :: Midlands Partnership University NHS Foundation Trust](#))

PLEASE NOTE: There is a weight management service available – please see 'W'

Dietician (Paediatric – under 18) – send via letter direct to the dietician at Sir Robert Peel Hospital via letter and can be emailed:

Department of Paediatric Nutrition and Dietetics
Sir Robert Peel Hospital
Mile Oak
Tamworth
Staffs
B78 3NG
Tel: 01827 263800 ext 8240
email: childrensdiet@mpft.nhs.uk

Update sent 13.01.25 from the ICB outlining changes to the paediatric dietician service for info:

Reason for change

The Paediatric Dietetic services had reached a critical point where there was a recognised risk to quality and patient safety due to the increased demand and excessive wait times of more than 65wks for a new appointment. As a result service providers had to implement measures to manage some of this demand, protect the safety of patients already on the waiting list and maintain the viability of the services.

The decision to amend the referral criteria ensures that we have a consistent approach across the system; this criteria has already been implemented by UHNM for North Staffs / Stoke and has been in place for a significant period of time.

Impact on Primary Care

It is expected that the impact of the decision to restrict the criteria will have a minimal impact on Primary Care. Although practices will be asked to suitably challenge Cow's Milk Protein Allergy prior to referral by following national guidance; the number of children that fall under this category is small and on average, per practice, equates to 6 children over a 12mth period.

Prior Referrals – children and young people previously referred to the Paediatric Dietetic services and accepted will remain on the caseload. Children will not be discharged for management via Primary Care that no longer meet the criteria. The criteria will only apply to any new referrals from the 6 Jan 25.

Home Enteral Feeding (HEF) – it's important to stress that the closure of the HEF service, which commenced from 31 Oct 24 at MPFT, will not impact on primary care. These are complex children which primary care would not be expected to manage. There is an expectation that clinical responsibility for these children remains under the care of the acute discharging hospital whilst the closure to the service remains in place.

For children and young people not meeting criteria we have provided a number of resources / alternative referral routes as part of the referral criteria, links to provider websites and are currently in the process of establishing an ICS website to house all the information to support stakeholders

Next Steps

The measures implemented are interim; we will be reviewing the impact of these measures on a regular basis. Additionally, the ICB has committed to undertake a review of the service provision with an aim to ensure that we have a robust equitable provision across the Staffordshire and Stoke-on-Trent footprint that meets the needs of our local population; we will of course engage with Primary Care in terms of their views around this.

If you have any further questions or clarifications or are or are seeing any significant impacts that you would like to raise then please contact qualityadmin@staffsstoke.icb.nhs.uk

Many Thanks

Staffordshire and Stoke-on-Trent Integrated Care Board

However, for paediatric weight loss management these go to Time4Sport as follows:

Wayne Glover

Time 4 Sport, Michelin Sports Centre, Rosetree Avenue, Trent Vale, Stoke-on-Trent, ST4 6NL

Tele: 01782 40 96 77 / 07707 275 409

Website: www.time4sportuk.com

To refer use the link: <https://www.time4sportuk.com/t4w/booking/>

District Nurses/CIT – via integrated form on WEB to be emailed via the secretaries. Please complete form and then send via Accumail please. Their contact details are

Email: sst-tr.bltspa@nhs.net

Emergency Spa Phone: 07772944024 (not for patient use)

Drug (Methadone) Referrals – we now do not prescribe Methadone (we used to). Any existing users that were seen by JGW/JWW are now seen at STARS (Staffordshire Treatment and Recovery Service) – these are self-referrals and there is a link on Accrux.

DEXA Scan – for Cannock please note the form is accessed via the shared folder on EMIS as they are a controlled document and we cannot modify and HAS to be completed by the clinician – search DXA and the document is called RF758 RWT DXA Scan Referral v2 260325 – this can then be emailed as long as it has not been modified.

Burton also accept DEXA scan referrals and you can request via their radiology form – there is a saved DEXA one on Emis WEB in the GP's imaging folders.

Diabetic Podiatry – please use the normal podiatry form but FAO Advanced Diabetes Podiatrist and send as normal to Appt Booking Centre.

DVT – undertake a Wells score and refer either to Burton/Good Hope – see pathway at the end of this document for guidance (also on shared system in Referrals map under Clinical Protocols & Guidelines).

Eating Disorders – for patients over 18 please refer via letter to the Adult Eating Disorder Service, St Chad's House, St George's Hospital, Corporation Street, Stafford ST16 3AG (tel: 01785 783120/783122).

For patients 8-18 refer via form (on EMIS) to CAMHS Child and Young Person Eating Disorder Service. **You need to make sure there is clinical information from the past 2 weeks including height, weight, BP standing and sitting, organise the bloods and ECG.** There is also a questionnaire for the patient to complete or you to complete with the patient – this needs doing please – then send to secretaries so we can email.

Early Pregnancy Assessment Unit – clinician to call Burton on 01283 511511 ext 5759 and book the patient in and let the patient know. No need to do a letter referral.

Endoscopy – Open Access

~~There is an open access service based at Sir Robert Peel Hospital in Tamworth. Form in EMIS. This service was suspended due to Covid and has not been reinstated – you need to refer to consultant and they will triage and order if appropriate.~~

ECG

Can be done in-house – send task to reception to organise.

In addition, we can request a Home ECG recording to Burton via the form on EMIS in Diagnostics folder – following triage by them, a loan period will either be a 24 hour ECG or a 7 day spiderflash monitor.

You can also request a 72 hour ECG via Cannock Hospital and their form is also on EMIS in the Diagnostics folder. This is via appointment only, not a walk-in service. You need to complete the form, give it to the patient and tell them to call the service to make an appointment – the number is on the form.

Echocardiograms

We can request these direct from Burton – there is an Echo form on EMIS in the Diagnostics folder. Please complete and send via Accumail to Burton Referrals.

ENT –Urgent Clinical Assessment Service – for urgent referrals that need to be soon, the clinician needs to ring the Burton on 01283 566333 and ask for the QHB ENT on-call doctor to discuss the patient and then the doctor will make arrangements for them to be reviewed in the ENT Cas clinic if necessary.

Enuresis Child – We now direct these to the School Nurses via the 0-19 form (on WEB) – please complete we can email them. Please get the parent/guardian's verbal consent and note this on the consultation along with the **SCHOOL** details. Thanks.

Erectile Dysfunction – the clinics are quite limited for this and only at base hospitals (Queen's Burton, Good Hope, Birmingham Treatment Centre, Rowley Hall Stafford, New Cross) so warn the patient there are no local clinics. Also, all of them require the patient to have had a trial of a PDE5 inhibitor prior to referral (assuming no contra-indications), and most of them want the minimum investigations of PSA, Testosterone, Fasting Glucose and Urinalysis before they will accept the referral so please arrange the investigations.

Eye Casualty Referrals – please email to Queen's Hospital to bhft.eyecas@nhs.net (The extension numbers are 5085/6364). Or there is an urgent Triage option on ERS to New Cross Hospital.

Everyone Health – offers a range of services for the residents of Staffordshire, including a 12 week weight management course, an NHS health check, stopping smoking (for over 40's) which patient's can SELF-REFER to.

For weight management, patients can access a 12 week course of exercise/nutrition advice and they can self-refer – criteria is a BMI of 28+ with a long-term medical condition, or 30+ without. The nearest place to go in our area is the Friary Grange Leisure centre in Lichfield.

You can give the link to the website with all of the information regarding the services they have available to offer in Staffordshire <https://staffordshire.everyonehealth.co.uk/> which also gives the eligibility criteria.

[Home - Everyone Health Staffordshire](#)

At Everyone Health we've come up with a simple way to help you stay healthy in the long-term, from your own stop smoking advisor to weekly circuit classes. We are delivering our services both virtually via phone, and in face to face settings. If you need help and support to improve your health, please call staffordshire.everyonehealth.co.uk

Expediting Referrals

Due to the extensive wait lists in most specialities, patients will often call the hospital and say they need to be seen sooner. The hospital's response to this will always be if that is the case your GP needs to write a letter. However, this has to be on clinical need and not because the patient does not want to wait. Therefore, there is a process to follow that if they contact reception to ask for the doctor to write to the hospital, they are sent a link with a form to complete to outline why their symptoms have worsened/changed since their referral to warrant being moved up the list. The GP will review this and if in agreement they will dictate an expedite letter and we will send to the consultant's secretary. This would be the same if the GP had seen the patient in clinic and felt an expedite letter is required. However, be warned that most clinics have told us that there are no such things as expedite lists anymore, all referrals are triaged and placed on an appropriate place in the waiting list. In their words when we have contacted them "it's worth a try though....". It is just worth bearing this in mind regarding patient's expectations.

Falls Clinic – referred by form to the Falls Team at Tamworth - **[see integrated form on EMIS Web in Referrals Folder and PLEASE fill out, save and send us a lexacom – we email these.](#)**

Fertility – see 'I' for infertility

Fracture Clinic - we can refer to Burton via Burton referrals or 606 324 2279 via ERS under orthopaedics and choose the body part affected – this will then be triaged and directed to the correct consultant.

Gender Dysphoria – Transgender Clinic – patients need to be referred to

The Nottingham Centre for Transgender Health,
12 Broad Street,
Nottingham,
NG1 3AL

Tel: 0115 876 0160

Email: not-tr.gender-services@nhs.net

Referral Email Address: ReferralsNCTH@nottshc.nhs.uk

They will accept referrals without any prior psychological support. We can refer 17 years or over.

There is a lot of information for patients on their website:

<https://www.nottinghamshirehealthcare.nhs.uk/nottingham-centre-for-transgender-health>

We refer via FORM (saved on EMIS, please integrate and fill out in full - please put as much information as possible in the form. Please note there is up to a 2 year + waiting time for this service as at January 2022 (They are currently inviting patients referred in January 2019 for an appointment in due course).

There is also information re referral to **For Under 17 year olds** – please refer to CAMHS in the first instance – the Tavistock GIDS service has now been withdrawn but we can still referral over 17's to this service

[Referrals - Gender Identity Clinic – GIC](#)

Gender Identity Clinic

Lief House

3 Sumpter Close

Finchley Road

London

NW3 5HR

Please note they moved to new location in June 2020

Tel: 0208 938 7590

Email: GIC@nhs.net

GOS 18 Referrals – these should be scanned on and tasked to GP to be signed off so secretaries can refer with their past medical history and current medication. **Cataracts can only be referred via an accredited optician.**

Gynaecology Good Hope 1.04.24 - Gynaecology referrals for Good Hope Hospital can now only be sent via the Advice and Guidance pathway. We will tick the box to authorise they can convert to a referral, but they may just send advice back.

Gynae Physio – refer on the Continence form (to Pelvic Health Team) saved on EMIS, there is a tick box for physio – you must do an MSU to rule out infection/arrange treatment prior to referral.

Heart Failure/Cardiac Rehab – based at Stoneydelph but Phase II visits for all patients in Burntwood can only be instigated by a consultant referral.

01827 306115 Rebecca Jackson – Cardiac Nurse

01827 306116 Jane Fulford – Cardiac Nurse

01827 306119 Angela Hemphill - Administrator

Email: southhfsn@mpft.nhs.uk

Home Oxygen – this is now **not** generally organised by GP practices, normally only via Consultants when patients are discharged home on oxygen or only be prescribed **after patients have been assessed** by the Home Oxygen Team (for assessment there is a form on EMIS: SES Oxygen Assessment request form.)

With immediate effect all home oxygen prescriptions and supplies must be actioned by Baywater using the following link - <https://www.baywater.co.uk/clinicians-commissioners/our-therapies/oxygen/online-portal>

All prescribers can access patients' HOOF information and order oxygen using the Baywater Healthcare home oxygen portal link. There is a video on the page to guide you through logging in or

registration process if you do not already have an account. Emailed HOOFs will no longer be accepted by Baywater Healthcare.

If you are having difficulties with your registration, please contact Baywater direct on 0800 373580 for assistance. To arrange training please email contract ContractManagement@baywater.co.uk

For general enquiries you can contact them on

Helpline

0800 373 580

Email

healthuk@baywater.co.uk

Address

Baywater Healthcare
Wulvern House, Electra Way
Crewe
Cheshire
CW1 6GW

Hydrotherapy Referrals at Cannock Chase Hospital

Please send a referral letter and email to RWH-tr.MSKphysio@nhs.net There is no guarantee they will see the patient, but will reject if not appropriate.

ICB Policy for Low Clinical Value Procedures link:

[Policy for Low Clinical Value Procedures Staffordshire](#)

IFR – Individual Funding Requests

Email received from IFR Team on 2 June 2025 - As per the communications that you will shortly be receiving in the GP Bulletin, can you please ensure all clinicians are made aware of the amendments to the IFR policy [Individual Funding Requests - Staffordshire and Stoke-on-Trent, Integrated Care Board](#) . The significant amendments are:-

- Clarity on who can submit an IFR application form (i.e. Consultant should not delegate the completion of IFR forms to GPs – Requests are to come from the treating clinician).
- The removal that patients can submit IFR applications
- All IFR applications are to be type written AND must not solely refer to clinic letters
- Deletion that patients can submit supporting statements
- Addition that clinical photographs can be submitted to support the application, these MUST be taken by a trained medical photographer.
- The addition that psychological factors are not considered in relation to cosmetic procedures.
- Addition of the definition of incidence and prevalence

As from 1st July 2025, any IFR applications that do not comply to the IFR policy will be returned to the requester for re-submission in accordance with the updated policy.

The amended policy ensures that the ICB has a standardised and streamline approach for all IFR applications.

We would be grateful if you could cascade this information to all relevant staff and should you have any queries, please contact a member of the IFR Team.

Immunology – Needs to be a base hospital but only Birmingham Treatment Centre, Heartlands Hospital or Stoke Hospital (used to be Burton but now all Burton referrals are going to be under Stoke) so please warn the patient. There is now a Clinical Immunology & Allergy Clinic at County Hospital.

Infection Disease Notification – Please use the new online service for infectious disease notifications – link will be on DORA.

Clinicians, please use the online form as we will not have the information to be able to do this and quicker for you to do it direct, thank you, secretaries.

Notifying cases of infectious disease has become easier thanks to a new online service launched by UKHSA. Registered Medical Practitioners have a legal duty to notify any suspected or confirmed cases of any diseases included on the [notifiable list](#). This information goes to UKHSA to make sure that the right public health action is taken quickly to protect patients, their families, and the wider community.

Until now, notification has been through a paper, telephone, and email-based system. However, on Thursday 12, UKHSA launched '[Report a Notifiable Disease](#)' – a new online service which will mean notifications can be made quickly and easily via gov.uk. On this new page, they will be able to access a simple form which will take them quickly and easily through all the information which needs to be entered for a case, and this will be sent directly to UKHSA.

Urgent cases will still need to be called through to UKHSA, particularly out of hours to ensure prompt response. A paper form is also available to download on the gov.uk page for any colleagues who are unable to access the new online service. Further information about the process and training videos can be found on the web page.

Infertility Referrals – we routinely send these to Nurture Fertility at Burton (not actually at the hospital). We send in the female name but the male has to have had a sperm test at QHB in the last 12 months. If he has not, we need to arrange or he needs to ask his GP to arrange. (If he has had a semen analysis test done at Burton in the last 12 months there is no need for him to see his GP to be referred separately).

Also, the female needs up to date bloods and screening – these can differ if they have a regular or irregular cycle as follows:

REGULAR – Day 1-5 FSH & LH, Mid-luteal progesterone 7 days prior to onset of menses (occurring every 24 to 35 days), Chlamydia and Rubella (you do not need TSH or prolactin if regular).

IRREGULAR – Random FSH & LH, TSH, Prolactin. Chlamydia and Rubella

As stated above, they also need chlamydia status in the last 6 months, and rubella status in last 5 years.

You must advise the patient about Folic Acid and you must give advice re smoking and alcohol. Also if BMI is raised (>30 for females, >35 for males) then advise weight loss. **All this information is in the shared system in the Referrals folder under Burton Fertility.**

For semen analysis, please use form PRF769 Nurture Fertility Andrology Referral form which sends to Burton

Iron Transfusions - Haematology at QHB do not have a dedicated unit for iron transfusions. If you feel a patient requires an iron transfusion, then GPs can refer the patient directly to the Same Day Emergency Care (SDEC) at QHB. The dose of Ferinject is based on the patient's weight and haemoglobin and the usual dose is 1000mg followed by 500mg one week later. The indications for parenteral iron replacement is poor compliance, intolerance to oral iron or? malabsorption.

Lumps & Bumps – can book via e-Referral, and also hernias, to most local hospitals. Note, please refer to the ICB guidelines for benign cysts etc as Dermatology/Minor Surgery will reject.
[Policy for Low Clinical Value Procedures Staffordshire](#)

(Adult) Learning Disability Team – based at the Friary Centre, St Michael's Court - the team accept referrals only for adults diagnosed with LD as children – email is CLDTEast@mpft.nhs.uk. For queries, contact secretaries For adult ASD assessments these go via letter to the Neurodevelopmental Service under Dudley & Walsall MHT – neurodevelopmental.service@nhs.net

Lymphoedema Clinic at St Giles - There is a form on EMIS to refer to the clinic and you can Accumail this direct – Please make sure you fill out in full including the reason for referral and also the site of swelling, duration, pain/type, and all the other questions including that a DVT has been ruled out. ALSO please make sure you complete Cardiac and Renal Status or it will be rejected.

Please note: there are notes on the form for patients with a BMI >30 (The patient must be actively engaged in management of their weight and should be referred to a local weight management programme where possible. Please include relevant correspondence where applicable) and >40 (The patient must be referred to a specialist bariatric/obesity service and must be actively engaged in management of their weight before the referral can proceed. Please include relevant correspondence, where applicable).

MSK SERVICE - Physiotherapy / Orthopaedic opinion / Podiatric Surgery

AS FROM MARCH 2025, ALL ORTHOPAEDIC REFERRALS HAVE TO GO TO MSK (18 and over, below 18, refer paed physio – see below* ([you can access the referral form via EMIS in consultation by Add/Document/Create Letter/\(if not in the list click on the looking glass\)/Referral Forms/MSK Referral Form](#)))

Please complete the form and send a task to Team Leaders - TB & AB **They will send the Accurx message once the referral has been done.**

***MSK Pathway – over 18's only** (refer under 18's to paediatric physio)

To manage waiting lists effectively and to ensure that our patients are seen in a timely manner, all routine Orthopaedic referrals (i.e. not cancer referrals) must be sent to the Tier 3 MSK Triage service provided by MPFT before they can be referred into secondary care. This is stated within the Excluded and Restricted Procedure (ERP) Policy, from which the relevant excerpt is copied below. This is to ensure that patients who only require ongoing care are sent to a trust of their choice to receive secondary care, and those who do not are seen at a location closer to their home. This also maximises the capacity of appointment slots available in secondary care and contributes to the reduction of the waiting list going forward.

All onward referrals from MPFT will be sent to the Choice and Referral Centre (now known as the Elective Coordination Centre) where informed choice will be offered to patients, who will then be sent on to their chosen provider.

Consequently, as from Monday 3rd March 2025 all secondary care providers will only accept routine referrals that have been through the MSK Tier 3 service.

Can all practices please ensure that their staff and clinicians are fully aware of the enforcement of the policy from this date.

Excerpt from ERP:

“Unless stated as an exemption, all cases for patients aged 18 years and over will be referred from primary care to the Tier 3 Musculoskeletal (MSK) provider for clinical triage. Following clinical triage patients will be assessed and treated within the local tier 3 community or if there are any patients who have clinical ‘red flags or paediatrics should be referred directly to the acute service. The community service will be responsible for ensuring appropriate conservative and non-surgical treatment options are tried and have failed before referral for surgical opinion.

The assumption is that all cases referred for surgical opinion by the community service will be eligible for surgery in keeping with the criteria set out for various conditions in this policy. It is the responsibility of the receiving Provider to seek approval for all restricted procedures that they undertake in-line with their contracts with the ICB. Direct referrals into an acute setting that are not in line with above criteria should be returned to the referrer."

From: Staffordshire and Stoke-on-Trent Integrated Care Board

Maxillofacial – dictate letter to a base hospital and sent via ERS.

Memory Assessment Clinics - referral sent to MHSI Hub via integrated form [on EMIS web](#) – **PLEASE complete form or dictate contents** and do GPCOG/6CIT score, bloods (Serum Vit B12, Blood folate, FBC, LFT, Lipid, TFT, HbA1c, U&Es, Serum calcium, eGFR) and attach an ECG/MRI done in the last 3 months.

Secretaries will email all referrals. They will NOT accept referrals with pending bloods, we have to attach them.

Contact details for new referrals 0300 555 5001 – MHSI Hub

Contact details for open cases phone 0300 303 3427

Mental Health Services – there is an [integrated form on EMIS Web](#) and these are sent to the MHSI Hub, Block 6 at St Michael's Court, Lichfield (Tel: 03005555001 option 2), Secretaries will email referrals.

Migraine Clinics – normally refer to Neurology/Headache clinic. I know there are two specific clinics – one at the old QE and one at North Staffs. Please dictate and where to send. (**Note:** we do not have access to the Headache Clinic at the Colliery Practice Cannock).

MRI Scans – [refer via ICE to](#) Burton – Children can be referred to QHB – for babies they need sedating so a bed will have to be organised and them admitted on a day case basis. There is an open Scanner at Burton. If the scan you want is not on the ICE catalogue, you can send a paper request.

Cannock MRI Scanning (19 years and over)

Cannock now has a mobile MRI unit run by Cannock Council. Please note, they have steps up to the mobile so not suitable for wheelchair/mobility issues. They do not accept **under 19's** or contrast MRI's and you need to complete the safety questions on the form. There is a weight limit of 23 stone.

MS Clinical Nurse Specialist – refer to Amanda Taylor at Samuel Johnson via Rehab form and emailed to LAP (Local Access Point – same as District Nurses email).

MS Nurse at Cannock Chase Hospital contact email address is rwh-tr.msnurses@nhs.net

Nerve Conduction Studies/Carpal Tunnel – there is a hand/carpal tunnel clinic at Cannock that we can book via e-Referral so if applicable please dictate and tell patient they will be seen at Cannock and we will send them an appointment out. Or you can send to Consultant Neurophysiologist at QHB and we email a letter to Burton Referrals (not currently via ERS).

Neurology – please note there is NO neurology service at Burton. Neither can we refer to Derby as they are not an option for us to select on ERS and they will not accept email referrals. The only answer we have from them regarding this is that we are out of their area for this service.

Our closest hospital for this service is Cannock who see MS, Parkinson's, Bell's palsy, trigeminal neuralgia, BIH, migraine/headache, stroke, MND, unspecified neurological disorders, epilepsy and dystonia.

Robert Peel Tamworth have a neurology referrals but NOT Epilepsy.

The Manor and County Hospitals see all general neurology referrals. Manor do not have a specialist headache service.

Good Hope have a neurology service but they do NOT see obviously benign headache. Nor do they see dizziness/vertigo and advise referral to ENT, or blackouts that are more likely to be cardiac. In the first instance any referrals will have to go via their Advice & Guidance option.

Neuropsychology Service for South Staffs - please see the information below about the new service. It is form RF1058 and you can Accumail this directly yourselves.

Who do we see?

We see people living in the community, whose GPs fall within our South Staffs. geographical area (we can check if you're unsure), and who have psychological problems associated with acquired brain injury and long-term neurological conditions.

Who don't we see?

In the absence of a diagnosed or suspected neurological condition, we do not see patients for assessment or intervention in the context of neurodevelopmental conditions, learning disability, specific learning difficulties, or functional neurological disorders.

Where a diagnosed or suspected dementia is the likely aetiology, referrals should be made to the Memory Assessment Service.

We don't see people whose primary needs would best be addressed by mental health services.

We don't see people whose circumstances fall within the remit of the MPFT Physical Health Psychology team.

Common reasons for referral

- Neuropsychological assessment to help characterise cognitive difficulties/impairments arising from brain injury or disease and inform approaches to managing them.
- Psychological assessment, therapies and interventions for problems arising in the context of and relating to neurological injury or illness. Psychotherapeutic intervention has a specific focus and is typically limited to a maximum of ten sessions.
- Cognitive rehabilitation may be provided on an individual basis, or as part of our Cognitive Rehabilitation Group. If cognitive rehabilitation is indicated by our assessment it may be delivered via either individual or group work, in agreement with the patient and subject to availability of groups at the time.
- Psychological intervention for families to help manage the impact of neurological illness or injury of their relative.

Please note that our service DOES NOT provide medical input or an MDT approach.

Who and how to refer?

Our referrals are primarily from medical consultants, psychology colleagues and GPs, but we also accept referrals from other healthcare professionals including members of community rehabilitation teams. Please ensure that any potential referral is discussed with your patient and consent gained prior

to the referral being made. Completed referral forms can be posted to the address on the first page of the referral form or emailed to the department's secure email address.

What we need from you, please

Information is key to our referral triage process. We are not able to accept referrals where there are key aspects of information missing; in these cases they will be returned to the referrer for elaboration. Referred patients will not be added to our waiting list until a complete referral is received. Thank you.

Occupational Therapy/Rehab – via integrated form and emailed to the LAP (Local Access Point). If long-term care is needed and there is a care package in place, please send to the ILCT (integrated local care team) via the Single Point of Access for Health and Social Care (same place as Social Services/District Nurse referrals).

If no current care in place, then the GP is to ring Staffordshire Cares on 0300 111 8010 and they will generate a referral – also contact them if OT is needed in addition to the ILCT team.

Ophthalmology Urgent/Eye Casualty Referrals – please email to Queen's Hospital to bhft.eyecas@nhs.net (The extension numbers are 5085/6364). Or there is an urgent Triage option on ERS to New Cross Hospital (also see the information above for CUES)

Orthotics – based at Samuel Johnson – there is a form on EMIS web to complete and we will email. This includes surgical belts and insoles. (Secretaries: Orthotics referrals need to be emailed to: opcare.burtonorthotics@nhs.net)

Orthopaedic referrals – see MSK pathway above.

Paediatric ASD and ADHD referrals – see A above

Please note, as from February 2025, there is a new form for all Child Neurodevelopmental referrals – these should be done via the education provider and parents - please see message from MPFT:

The new referral form replaces all previous referral forms for Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD) and Autism Spectrum Condition (ASC) assessment requests. It is applicable to all of MPFT Children's Services and is the start of work towards an integrated Neurodevelopmental Pathway. We have streamlined the form and integrated all the information that we require to be able to triage assessment requests – **there will no longer be a school report form in addition to this information.**

This is a referral form for a specialist assessment. Before this can be carried out it is important that a child/ young person's needs are assessed and supported as the first step in understanding their presenting difficulties.

- The graduated response toolkit is a resource for schools and colleges to help make sure children and young people with Special Educational Needs reach their full potential, evidence will be required to demonstrate how a graduated response has been followed to support the child/ young person's needs within their educational setting prior to referral. Further information can be found at Graduated response toolkit - Staffordshire County Council
- Further information around taking a needs led approach can be found in the leaflet 'ADHD Assessment Requests' on our website Professionals :: Midlands Partnership University NHS Foundation Trust (mpft.nhs.uk)

- Further information regarding Autism assessments can be found via the CYP Autism Service website Children and Young People's Autism Service :: Midlands Partnership University NHS Foundation Trust (mpft.nhs.uk).

To ensure that our services are in the best position to understand a child or young person's needs **all sections of this referral form MUST be completed**. Additional reports can be provided when indicated as supporting evidence.

Referrals are accepted from professionals only. We advise that the professional that knows the child the best makes the referral together with their parent/carer. Usually this Professional would be from a child/young person's educational setting. If education are not making the referral, detailed information from education is required.

Please note that there is no change to how referrals are made to CAMHS and Community Paediatrics. Mental health referrals continue to be made on the CAMHS referral form, and concerns about development are to be made on the Community Paediatrics referral form.

[There is an information sheet on Accurx you can send to the parent \(copy here\)](#)

The accurx is called Child ADHD/ASD Info to Parent re referral request.

Paediatric – Community Paediatrician – via form - these are emailed to the East Community Paediatrics Team at Lanxess House, Burton – appointments are given in local clinics (normally Salters Meadow). Check the EXCLUSIONS. PLEASE NOTE: see above for ADHD referrals.

Paediatric/Children's Physiotherapy – these referrals are sent via form to Beecroft Court in Cannock – there is advice on the form about what to refer and about unnecessary referrals so please check (re intoeing gait, flat feet and talipes etc). It is on WEB so you can autopopulate (and save and we can send via email like other forms. Please note: any person under 18 with an orthopaedic problem needs to be referred to the Paed physio in the first instance, we cannot refer to MSK.

Paediatric Dermatology – As from 1.10.23 all paediatric dermatology that is going to Burton needs to be sent initially via A&G on ERS. (secretaries please tick box to give permission to convert the advice request to a referral). If they need to see the patient they will convert the referral and arrange an OP appointment – they may send interim advice to the GP to treat the patient in the interim whilst waiting for an appt. If the pt not needed to be seen, they will sent advice to GP via A&G to support the GP in primary care. Community Dermatology, Health Harmonie, will see all ages, **but no under 16 year olds for any surgical procedures**.

Paediatric – Dietician (under 18) – see D for dietician above.

Paediatric MRI – please note for babies and young children who cannot lay long enough they will need to be sedated so will need to be admitted on a day case to BURTON (Cannock do not see under 18's).

Paediatric Hot Clinic - we can email a letter to the Rapid Access Paediatric Clinic to Burton Referrals for under 16 year olds.

Paediatric – Surgery – base hospital only, ask patients where they prefer please. For umbilical hernias, BCH do not accept these under 18 months.

Pain Management – also see ‘C’ Chronic Pain Management Service – over 18’s only – see referral criteria notes saved at the end of this document and refer via the form (on EMIS) to the Chronic Pain Management Service over at Burton and we can send via ERS or email them (NOTE: Do not use MSK).

Palliative/St Giles Hospice – as at 1 June 2025, there has been a change to the way we refer to the Hospice – the forms are now to be completed by the clinician online via their website under “How Can We Help”. This is to ensure the correct information is given at the time of referral, there is no Word documents we can download. The link to the website is [St Giles - Make a Referral](#)

Parkinson’s Nurse Specialist – refer to the Clinical Nurse Specialist (currently Karen Wrotchford) at Samuel Johnson Hospital via OT/Rehab form and send to LAP (Local Access Point). (T:01543 728142)

Perinatal Mental Health – you can refer to the local MPFT team via form which is on EMIS – we sent via email to the perinatal.communityteam@mpft.nhs.uk

Physiotherapy – via MSK SERVICE

for **Domiciliary Physiotherapy/mobility aids** use the Community Physiotherapy form which we send to SJH

for **Children’s/Paediatric Physiotherapy** see ‘P’ above

for **Antenatal Physio** email referrals direct to Physio at Burton by letter.

Plastic surgery – There are obviously strict guidelines for any aesthetic plastic surgery referrals; please see the clinical guidelines for procedures of low clinical value: [ICB Policy - Procedures of Low Clinical Value](#)

Podiatry – (NOT Podiatric SURGERY including hallux valgus, hammer toes, claw toes, these go to MSK team) – please complete the integrated form on WEB and request secretaries to email it. Please make sure they meet the eligibility criteria on the form.

Private Referrals – see instructions at the end of this document click→ [Private Referrals](#)

Reports

These are all dealt with by the Business Admin Reports team. All requests are sent to them and entered onto a log and fees are arranged/paid via them. (Secretaries – any reports/TWMIC letters we type we save on the records and task the Reports Team to let them know the letter is done and they will then action it).

Radiology/X-ray Requests – please see the information at the beginning of this document. Please send via ICE where possible.

Rapid Access Chest Pain Referral – either to Burton or Good Hope by [integrated form please which can be generated from the consultation screen in EMIS Web under Referral forms. Please then dictate a message/send a task to secretaries who will send via ERS.](#) Make sure your organise the requisite bloods, ECG and commence medication as advised on the form. Tell the patient to take a copy of the ECG with them to any appointment.

Rapid Access TIA Clinics – these are held at Burton or Good Hope – there are integrated forms on EMIS and the New referrals map on the **shared system**. Secretaries email them.

ReSPECT Form – this has been integrated and is on EMIS

SAFEGUARDING CONCERNS – They prefer a call from a clinician in the first instance.

If you have a safeguarding concern regarding a child or vulnerable adult please use the relevant contact for advice and referral: Please note, this information is on the wall of every clinical room and also on your desk top:

SAFEGUARDING CHILDREN

First Response Team - 0800 1313 126

<https://www.staffordshire.gov.uk/Care-for-children-and-families/Childprotection/Report-a-concern-online.aspx>

SAFEGUARDING ADULTS

Staffordshire County Council - 0345 604 2719

<https://www.ssaspb.org.uk/Reporting-Abuse/Reporting-Abuse.aspx>

Outside Office hours - 0345 604 2886 or email: eds.team.manager@staffordshire.gov.uk

SALT – this is now done via form (you should have these and Reception have a master copy and there is also an electronic copy on the **shared system**) – Please ensure you use the correct referral form for either Adults with Learning Disability or Acquired Adults as they are different teams for Swallowing difficulties (the swallowing questions MUST be completed). They now operate an open referral system but all referrals must have GP approval even if no signature required. Number for SALT at SJH is 01543 412967 ext 3001.

Children's Salt referrals are at Greenhill Health Centre – form on EMIS.

Semen Analysis – please use form PRF769 Nurture Fertility Andrology Referral form which sends to Burton

Please note it asks for details whether it is for a normal analysis (reproductive) or post-vasectomy as there are two different options. For any post-vasectomy tests, the patient must go back to the provider who performed the surgery. Inform patient they will hear direct from the clinic with an appointment. Form to be accumulated to dhft.bfc referrals@nhs.net

Sexual Health Services

The latest service information can be found on our website www.openclinic.org.uk.

Sleep Apnoea – If you are sending to Burton, this is done via the Respiratory team Clinical Assessment Service – they will triage the referral and then contact the pt to tell them outcome and next steps – this is NOT an appointment.

(**secretaries** – please note that you need to select Respiratory in ERS, not Sleep Medicine. You should be able to defer to provider, but if there are appts (as above, these are telephone outcome appointments only), choose an appointment time and send the letter to the pt with the accurx message CAS Respiratory text to pt. ALSO, the service needs the minimum information of an Epworth Sleepiness Scale score or Stop Bang score AND a BMI (and preferable a neck circumference but not mandatory). If there is not the minimum info, then go back to referring clinician to get these and then ask them to resend us the referral.

Social Services – these need to go to Staffordshire Cares. Clinicians can phone to make a referral on 0300 111 8010 (need to do this if urgent please) – or via a dictated letter and secretaries will email them. (for Community Intervention Team there is a form on WEB – you can also use DN form and tick the CIT box).

Social Prescribing Link Worker – a service where a Link Worker comes into the practice to run clinics and we can refer frequent flyers to them (i.e. lonely, chronic illness, families with autism and learning difficulties, low level mental health inc anxiety and depression). Please complete the Social Prescribing referral form saved on EMIS, save it in the patient's notes and then task the Link Worker (currently Jessica Ryan) the details and she will access the form. There will be a weekly clinic and there will be an assessment at the start and end of the process and notes will be saved on the patient's records. Please complete form and email to Jessica.ryan@staffs.nhs.uk

Spirometry Service Langton MC Lichfield - There is a spirometry service we can currently access for our patients which is operating out of Langton Medical Centre in Lichfield.

I have uploaded the referral form on EMIS in the Darwin Doctors Folders/Diagnostics/DAR-Spirometry Referral Langton. The process is for the clinician to complete the form in full, and also make a note of the patient's current height, weight and observations in the patient's records (they will access this information on the patient's records via EMIS) and then lexacom/task the secretaries for us to action.

Please then sent a task to the Team Leads Care Navigators who will then book an appointment for the patient via the cross-organisational slots on EMIS and Langton will contact the patient with the appointment time/date and information letter.

Please follow the link to read the Standard Operating Procedure which includes the referral process, exclusion criteria and how you will get the results. [SOP Spirometry Langton](#)

Secretaries – please see instructions on the SOP above how to book an appointment. Langton will then contact the patient with the appointment time/date and they send an information letter. This service has been extended, but sometimes there are no appointments loaded.

Spirometry at Cannock Hospital - There is a GP direct access spirometry referral for Cannock but they may also be seen at New Cross Hospital depending on availability. NO UNDER 18'S – these would be a respiratory referral.

Spinal Surgery – as per ICB guidelines, all routine referrals need to be sent to MSK for onward referral to secondary care if appropriate including urgent Spinal Referrals

Staying Well Clinics - As from 1st April 2022 all referrals are to be made on the electronic referral system. All referrals must have a completed referral form (this is an integrated form on EMIS) – the Staying Well SPOC appointments will no longer be available. (Secretaries – to locate on eRS it is Community Healthcare/ Prevention and Screening/ Staying Well Service RRE

Stoma Care – Hospital based

The stoma care nurses are based at Burton. As at 01.08.24 the nurse that covers this area is Kerry Shakespeare. If you need to refer a patient to her you can email it on

kerry.shakespeare@securicaremedical.co.uk. Their extension number is 01283566333 ext 2122.

Stoma Care provided by Amcare

Website: [Amcare by Convatec - Specialist stoma nurses](#)

As a user of stoma supplies, patients are entitled to a FREE annual face to face consultation with one of Amcare's specialist nurses. This is an opportunity for patients to talk about any issues they may be having with their health and all products used. Nurses are happy to see customers in their own homes, GP surgeries, or community clinics.

The patient can call to request a nurse review Call - UK: **0800 88 50 50**

Stroke Team (Stroke Nurse is Kate) – refer to the Community Stroke Team at Stoneydelph Health Centre by the OT/Rehab form on EMIS. Tel: 01827 891069

TWMIC letters

These should be organised through the Business Admin Reports team. The patient is to complete a Fee Pack request with the details of their request and this will be entered onto their log and the Reports team will organise the fee to be paid and get the letter to them once typed. (Secretaries – when letter is dictated/tasked to us, please type, save on notes and task the Business Admin Team to let them know they can action it).

Termination of Pregnancy - As from 1st April 2022 patients will self-refer to **NUPAS** via telephone on 0333 004 666 which will be open 7 days a week from 8am until 8pm – there is no need for a GP referral.

New contracts commissioned in the area from June 2025 – see link for details: [New contracts for TOPS as at June 2025](#)

Tissue Viability –(phone number 01889 571435) For all mobile patients that our Practice Nurses can't deal with, we would refer via the Ambulatory referral form to SPA – they deal with them in clinic twice a month to advise on any difficulty they are having.

For all housebound patients in the first instance these should be referred to the District Nurses on a normal District Nurse form - they will then contact the Tissue Viability if it is something they can't manage.

For all patients in care homes/nursing homes, they contact Tissue Viability themselves. They all have forms and normally they take photos and send those to Tissue Viability who advise them. If they don't have a form they need to call Tissue Viability.

So generally as a practice we don't refer direct to Tissue Viability - unless maybe there is an obscure or weird wound you want dealing with that you know the PN or DN's won't see, or you want advice over and above what the District Nurses are doing, but normally they are in touch with Tissue Viability anyway. We do not have a tissue viability form on our system for this reason. They do have an email address if we do want to contact them via email – tissue.viability7@nhs.net

Transgender Clinic – patients need to be referred to

The Nottingham Centre for Transgender Health,
12 Broad Street,
Nottingham,
NG1 3AL

Tel: 0115 876 0160

Email: not-tr.gender-services@nhs.net

They will accept referrals without any prior psychological support. We can refer 17 years or over.

There is a lot of information for patients on their website:

<https://www.nottinghamshirehealthcare.nhs.uk/nottingham-centre-for-transgender-health>

We refer via FORM (saved on EMIS, please integrate and fill out in full - please put as much information as possible in the form. Please note there is up to a 2 year + waiting time for this service as at January 2022 (They are currently inviting patients referred in January 2019 for an appointment in due course).

For Under 17 year olds – please refer to CAMHS in the first instance. Tavistock is **not** now an option to refer to.

Ultrasound – Community Service – these can be carried out by Health Harmonie at various locations and these do change (they could be Cannock/Lichfield/Tamworth). Please complete form and save and send to secretaries as these go via ERS. Secretaries – please select the Tamworth option on ERS as no longer a Burntwood option.

You cannot refer directly for breast or axilla swellings/lumps, these have to go to Breast Clinic or for neck/thyroid these need to go to ENT. Other exclusions: cardiac imaging, chest, ophthalmology, obstetric scans.

Vascular – dictate letter and refer to a base hospital. For DVT see the DVT pathway on the shared system under Referrals/Clinical Protocols & Guidelines (also at the end of this document). You can refer varicose veins which are symptomatic (guidance under the protocols) but it seems different hospitals have different criteria as below.

Varicose Veins criteria listed for below hospitals:

Varicose veins are a restricted service by the ICB POLCV [Policy for Low Clinical Value Procedures Staffordshire](#) – Surgery (stripping of veins) is only routinely commissioned when the patient meets one or more of the following criteria:

- Varicose veins which have bled and are at risk of bleeding again

OR

- A history of varicose ulceration

OR

- Signs of prolonged venous hypertension (haemasiderin, pigmentation, eczema, induration lipodermatosclerosis), or significant oedema associated with skin changes)

OR

- Superficial thrombophlebitis in association with varicose veins OR • Significant symptoms attributable to chronic venous insufficiency which are resulting in significant functional impairment

Queen's Hospital Burton Varicose Veins - they need to meet criteria above.

Good Hope - You have to use the Birmingham VV referral form and meet the following criteria AND PROVIDE A PHOTOGRAPH to prove referral needed: (and also see exclusions)

Under the criteria agreed with the ICB they are unable to offer appointments or treatment for uncomplicated varicose veins, i.e. veins that have not caused significant thrombophlebitis, significant skin damage, bleeding or ulceration. If the patient meets the criteria then please complete and return the Birmingham Vascular Centre's varicose veins referral form (integrated on EMIS) more information is available on the website <https://www.bvc.health/varicose-veins>

Exclusions	Guidance
Significant bleeding from varicose veins	Refer to on call vascular service call 0121 424 2000
Active venous leg ulcer	Refer to venous leg ulcer service via vascular RAS
Thread/spider or reticular veins	Treatment not currently offered
Uncomplicated varicose veins	Treatment not currently offered

Vasectomy (No scalpel service) – this is now an AQP service. Currently we can refer via Brewood Medical Services via ERS. Please counsel the patient and state in letter you have done so and dictate referral or fill out form – many thanks.

Weight Management

NHS Digital Weight Management Referral – This is a weight management service available for patients with elevated BMI who have a diagnosis of type 1 or 2 diabetes or hypertension. *The practice will be paid for each referral*

The referral form is NHS+I digital weight management and can be found in EMIS referral forms in the usual way, searching for 'weight' will find it. It is a tier 3 service that should have the newer weight loss treatments such as GLP agonists available to prescribe

Referrals to the NHS Digital Weight Management Programme are accepted for those who meet all of the following criteria:

- Over the age of 18
- Has a BMI of 30+ (adjusted to ≥ 27.5 for people from Black, Asian and ethnic minority backgrounds)
- Has a diagnosis of diabetes (type 1 or type 2) or hypertension or both.
- Has access to a smartphone, tablet, or computer with internet access.

Exclusion criteria

An individual who meets any one or more of the following exclusion criteria is not eligible to access the service and will not be eligible for referral:

- Recorded as having moderate or severe frailty
- Is pregnant
- Has an active eating disorder
- People for whom a weight management programme is considered to pose greater risk of harm than benefit
- Has had bariatric surgery in the last two years.

For people aged over 80 years, the referrer will need to confirm on the referral form that a weight management programme is considered likely to pose greater benefit than harm.

This is a digital document and you cannot edit it after generating. Please make sure the required information is coded on the patient's notes prior to you creating the form.

Bariatric surgery

Patients who wish to be considered for bariatric surgery should be referred to the Adult Dietetics Service for support prior to referral to Tier 4 services. The criteria is on the shared system (you can follow link for more info: [Adult Dietetics - Referral Criteria South Staffordshire](#))

UPDATE February 2026 – further to the info below, we have now received an update from the Bariatric team at Walsall Manor to say due to high demand they are no longer accepting patients for consideration of bariatric surgery – this has been escalated to management to look into – in the meantime please just refer to Adult Dieticians.

~~For direct referrals the only bariatric service we are aware of is the Manor Hospital and if they have had sufficient work up, you can refer them to attend a surgical weight management clinic in preparation for surgery – for GLP-1 injection requests and for patients who have had private bariatric surgery and want follow up, this is their current advice as at March 2025:~~

~~“Thank you for referring your patient to our service, please be aware if your referral suggests the primary indication is for medical weight management, which would fundamentally involve medication/injection therapy and not surgery, Walsall CCG does not currently fund a tier 3 medical weight management service. Therefore, the referral will be rejected.”~~

If your referral relates to procedure's done outside the Trust i.e. private surgery/surgery abroad, please manage this in the community, refer to <https://bomss.org/gp-hub/> and advise lifelong A-Z vitamins. The referral will be rejected and returned for you to manage within the community.

Yours sincerely,
Mr. S Mirza
Consultant Bariatric/Upper GI Surgeon (Bariatric Lead)
Deputy Chief Medical Officer”

Weight Loss Injections

23 June 2025: From 23 June 2025, following approval by NICE, tirzepatide (Mounjaro®) will be available in the NHS for eligible patients who meet the strict, nationally-set, criteria. The current criteria is that patients are those with a BMI of 40 or higher, and with four or more of the qualifying comorbidities (hypertension, dyslipidaemia, obstructive sleep apnoea, cardiovascular disease and type 2 diabetes) will be eligible for assessment to identify their suitability for Mounjaro. Anyone not meeting these criteria will not be eligible for assessment in the first year of the drug being available.

For more information about alternative local weight management services, visit the ICS website - [Local Weight Management services - Staffordshire and Stoke-on-Trent, ICS](#) .

Weight Management - Everyone Health – offers a range of services for the residents of Staffordshire, including a 12 week weight management course, an NHS health check, stopping smoking (for over 40's) which patient's can SELF-REFER to.

For weight management, patients can access a 12 week course of exercise/nutrition advice and they can self-refer – criteria is a BMI of 28+ with a long-term medical condition, or 30+ without. The nearest place to go in our area is the Friary Grange Leisure centre in Lichfield.

You can give the link to the website with all of the information regarding the services they have available to offer in Staffordshire <https://staffordshire.everyonehealth.co.uk/> which also gives the eligibility criteria.

Wheelchair Referrals – via Form and dealt with by either Alyson or Tammie, Team Leaders in Admin. The provision of the wheelchair service has now moved to AJM Wheelchair Services. This is a lengthy form for either manual or powered – they require details including measuring details etc and much more! Please see form. There is also a link for you to check details and eligibility <https://staffordshireandstoke.wheelchair.services/>

Main service centre

Unit J-L Daniel Platts Way
Stoke-on-Trent
ST6 4JU

Satellite service centre

Units 8 and 9 Central Park
Progress Drive
Cannock
WS11 0JF

Tel: 0808 175 3996

NHS email: AJM.ssotwheelchairservice@nhs.net

2WW REFERRALS

Instructions to Create a 2WW Referral form

Please generate the form on EMIS and send an immediate Lexacom dictation as below.

In EMIS, create the form as below:

- In EMIS, make sure you are on the correct patient and in a consultation.
- Select DOCUMENT
- Select CREATE Letter - NOTE: if you have not chosen the form you require previously, please select the 'looking glass' on the lower right hand side of the box and follow the instructions below:
 - Click ONCE on Doctors Forms
 - Click ONCE to select 2WW Referrals folder
 - Click ONCE to select which hospital folder you require – we usually use Queen's Hospital, Burton. (Take care when referring to breast clinic, this is a separate form to Derby (but they are seen at Burton). Or if you want to refer to Good Hope for example use the UHB form (the patient should bear in mind they may be offered an appointment at Solihull or Heartlands or the QEHB).
 - Click TWICE to select the correct 2WW form which will then open for you.
 - The next time you want to use this form, it should be on your first list when you CREATE a document.
- Once you have selected the correct form, fill out the prompts as requested – you can edit these later if required. Please ensure you have ticked all appropriate boxes
- Select OK
- Save it on the patient's records and send a dictation marked IMMEDIATE to tell us the form is ready to send – if you don't have Lexacom send an urgent patient task.
- There is a 'Why Have I Been Given a 2WW Appointment' information sheet on the same folder you can print off and give it to the patient.

How to send a dictation on Lexacom

- Pull in patient's details by using the integrated button (sideways triangle) or fill in the patient's name/emis number
- Priority – select IMMEDIATE
- Specialty – select 2WW
- Record a voice file to say 'Two week wait to send please'
- Press Send.
This will pop up on the secretaries' desktops in RED and will differentiate between the routine and urgent referrals we have on the list.

Please ask the patient to contact us after ONE WEEK if they have not had any communication from us or the hospital.

Your access to rapid Teledermatology Advice & Guidance

There is clinicians' access to rapid Teledermatology Advice & Guidance via Consultant Connect: (note to clinicians: this has been sent to you via your NHS.net email addresses)

- The average response time for Teledermatology queries is 1 working day
- All images taken using the app are automatically saved in an IG secure online cloud, and never to your phone
- A PDF summary will automatically be sent to your NHS email address

Join the increasing number of clinicians in your area who are making the most of this service by downloading the free Consultant Connect App from the [App Store](#) or [Google Play](#). On the app, you will also see all the specialties available to you and their operating hours.

Once you have an account, you can also upload photos and files and share them for advice. Log in to the secure desktop platform here [Login | Consultant Connect](#)

- Go to 'Messages' within the secure platform and start a new message by clicking on the button in the top right-hand corner
- For more information, please see this [Patient Initiated Teledermatology User Guid](#)

For more information, please see the below useful links: (Ctrl +click to follow link)

- [User Guide on taking the best photos for Teledermatology](#)
- [Short demo video on Photo Messaging Advice & Guidance via the Consultant Connect App](#)

If you have any questions or would like to book a quick 10-minute demo on how to use Teledermatology, please contact Marija Tofts via the details below.

Best wishes,

Marija Tofts
Consultant Connect
Tel: 01865 261 467
Marija.tofts@consultantconnect.org.uk

PAIN MANAGEMENT REFERRALS

QUICK TIPS TO FOLLOW BEFORE REFERRAL TO CHRONIC PAIN MANAGEMENT SERVICE

1. Ensure that patients' expectations are managed that they will be referred for pain relief and not a cure. (Up to 30-40% pain relief).
2. Patients are advised to come with open mind, as pain may not be cured, but the goal will be to improve function and improve living standard.
3. If possible for therapeutic purposes ensure that patients are sent for necessary investigations, to reduce their anxiety and fear avoidance.
4. Patients are made aware that their pain is genuine, even if standard investigations they underwent are within normal parameters.
5. Please check if they are actually taking their medications before seeking further advice.
6. Some medications can cause significant side effects, can you please ensure that they are aware that the side-effects will wear off after six weeks and not to stop them within one week if side effects are manageable.
7. Ensure that patients are referred to Physiotherapeutic Management before seeking Chronic Pain Service (Back to basics).
8. Ensure that all possible surgical or therapeutic routes are exhausted before, to prevent cure searching of the patients.
9. Please do not refer if they are waiting for related surgery, in such situation follow medicine management guidance for controlling pain relief.

QUICK REFERRAL GUIDE THE CHRONIC PAIN MANAGEMENT SERVICE

REFERRAL CRITERIA

- ◇ Patient must be suffering from severe symptoms more than 3-6 months.
- ◇ The patient's participation in daily activities is severely limited.
- ◇ The patient's pain has been treated unsuccessfully with primary surgical/medical management, physiotherapy and not suitable for surgical procedures.

EXCLUSION CRITERIA

- ◇ Palliative pain relief
- ◇ Suffering from a rapidly deteriorating disease or condition
- ◇ History of a cancer potentially related to the pain (RED FLAG)

- ◇ Displays symptoms of a spinal tumour
- ◇ Non-mechanical pain that is constant and progressive and not related to activity or posture (RED FLAG)
- ◇ Suffering from the acute phase of a violent trauma
- ◇ Has a psychosis or a severe impairment.
- ◇ Addiction of illegal drugs.

REFERRAL PROCESS

Referral form and/or dictated letter with maximum information about patient with all previous interventional information can be sent to us through:

- ◇ Email: cpms.admin@mpft.nhs.uk
- ◇ Post :
Chronic Pain Management Service
Edwin House, Second Avenue,
Centrum 100,
Burton on Trent
DE14 2WF
- ◇ Choose and Book (ERS)

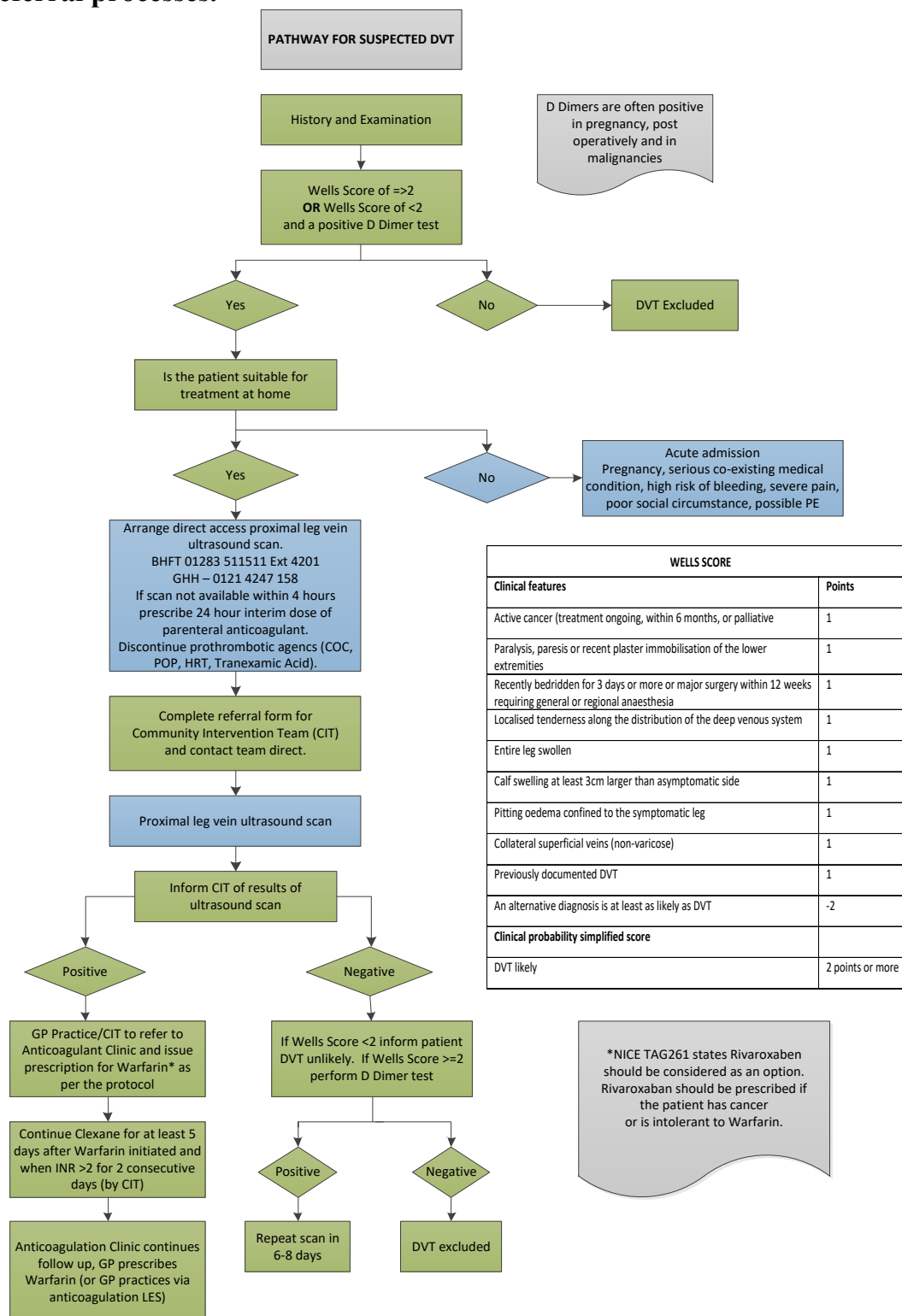
CONTACT PHONE NUMBER

01283 507131

COMPLIMENTS OR COMMENTS

ashish.khiloshiya@mpft.nhs.uk

DVT REFERRALS - East Staffs Steering Group on 8.10.13, practices agreed to undertake a Wells Score on all patients being referred for query DVT. This will commence from November 2013. They have asked us to distribute to our Practices to support this action and ask that you consider implementing this within our CCG, to provide consistency within referral processes.



References: Nice Guidance CG144 June 2012
Rivaroxaban for the treatment of DVT and prevention of recurrent DVT and PE TAG261 July 2012

PRIVATE REFERRALS

If a patient wishes to have a private referral, they need to arrange this themselves with the hospital of their choice or contact their insurance provider (our most local private hospital is Spire Little Aston at Sutton Coldfield).

Please make sure the patient is aware that they must allow at least 7-10 working days between seeing you and making an appointment to give us time to arrange for the letter to be ready (unless clinically urgent decided by you).

Once they have made the appointment please ask them to contact reception and leave details of who they are seeing, at which hospital and when. They can either have their letter sent via Accurx or will need to collect their referral letter prior to their appointment and take it with them. However for Spire Little Aston we can send these electronically via Spire Connect. For imaging we need a letter that we can electronically sign.

For insurance companies or providers that say they need the letter first, we can only do open letters for this reason and we need to know the speciality.

Then please dictate letter to secretaries, the consultant details etc will be added on when received and we will send it to them via Accurx email. If they want a paper copy they will need to come into a reception and request a receptionist print a copy.

**Any queries, please check with reception/secretaries.
Many thanks**

Practice Email: darwinmedical.practice@nhs.net

Secretaries Email: darwin.secretaries@nhs.net